

HUMAN RESOURCES
OFFICIAL POLICY DOCUMENT

INTERN POLICY

*Comprehensive Guidelines for Internship Hiring, Management,
Conduct, Stipend, Performance & Supervision*

Document Version	v1.0
Effective Date	June 2025
Applicable To	All Interns, Supervisors & HR Personnel
Owner	Human Resources Department

This document is strictly confidential and intended for internal use only.

1. Purpose, Scope & Policy Overview

This Intern Policy establishes a comprehensive, standardized framework governing every aspect of internship engagement at the Company — from the initial stages of talent identification and recruitment, through onboarding, daily conduct, performance evaluation, stipend administration, and, where applicable, the pathway to a full-time Pre-Placement Offer (PPO). The policy exists to ensure that interns receive a structured, enriching professional experience while the Company benefits from emerging talent in a clearly defined and legally compliant manner.

This policy applies universally to all interns regardless of domain (Technology, Product, Design, Marketing, Sales, Finance, Operations, Legal, HR, Research & Development, Content, or any other function), their mode of recruitment (on-campus, off-campus, cold outreach, or referral), or their engagement type (paid internship, academic credit internship, or project-based internship). Every intern, supervisor, departmental manager, and HR team member is expected to read, understand, and comply with this policy in its entirety.

1.1 Why This Policy Exists

Internships are one of the most powerful talent pipelines available to any growing organization. When managed well, interns bring fresh perspectives, modern academic knowledge, and genuine enthusiasm. Mismanaged internships, on the other hand, lead to wasted resources, reputational damage, and poor conversion rates into full-time roles. This policy creates a clear, consistent, and fair environment for all parties.

Core Objectives of This Policy

- Define clear hiring channels and ensure equitable access for all intern candidates
- Establish transparent and competitive stipend structures across all domains
- Create a merit-based, clearly communicated pathway to Pre-Placement Offers (PPO)
- Set behavioral, ethical, and professional standards that all interns must maintain
- Standardize attendance norms for both in-office and work-from-home modalities
- Ensure every intern is assigned meaningful, skill-appropriate project work
- Specify measurable performance expectations and evaluation criteria
- Govern system and data access privileges granted to interns
- Clarify supervisory responsibilities and remedial procedures when expectations are not met
- Protect the Company from legal, reputational, and operational risk associated with intern engagement

2. Intern Hiring: Channels, Process & Standards

The Company recruits interns through four primary channels: on-campus recruitment, off-campus recruitment, cold outreach (initiated by either the Company or the candidate), and employee referrals. Each channel has distinct processes, timelines, and evaluation criteria. Regardless of channel, every intern candidate must pass the same baseline selection criteria and complete the same onboarding process.

2.1 On-Campus Recruitment

On-campus recruitment is the Company's highest-volume hiring channel for interns, particularly for structured semester-long and summer internship programs. The HR Talent Acquisition team partners with Placement Cells and Training & Placement Officers (TPOs) at targeted universities and colleges.

Target Institution Categories

- Tier 1 Institutions: IITs, IIMs, NITs, BITS Pilani, top private engineering and management institutes (e.g., NMIMS, Symbiosis, Manipal)
- Tier 2 Institutions: State universities, regional engineering colleges, autonomous colleges with strong academic performance records
- Specialized Institutions: Design schools (NID, Srishti), law colleges (NLSIU, NLU), journalism schools, and film/media institutes for domain-specific roles
- Partnerships: The Company maintains an official Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) or annual placement partnership with at least 20 institutions, updated each academic year

On-Campus Process Flow

1. Pre-Season Planning (3–4 months before campus visits): HR prepares Job Descriptions (JDs) for all intern roles, coordinates internal headcount approval from department heads, and finalizes the list of target campuses for the academic year
2. TPO Engagement: HR submits company profiles, JDs, and internship offer letters (sample) to the institute's placement cell. A formal Pre-Placement Talk (PPT) date is confirmed
3. Pre-Placement Talk (PPT): A team of 2–3 representatives from the Company (HR + relevant department) visits the campus or conducts a virtual session. The PPT covers the Company's

business, culture, intern projects, stipend, and PPO conversion history. Q&A sessions allow students to evaluate fit

4. **Application & Resume Shortlisting:** Students submit resumes through the placement portal. HR, in coordination with the hiring department, shortlists based on CGPA, relevant coursework, projects, internship experience, and extracurriculars
5. **Assessment Round (if applicable):** Some roles require an aptitude test, coding challenge, or case study submission. This round is conducted on-campus or online, depending on institute norms
6. **Group Discussion / Case Presentation (optional):** For management, product, or consulting roles, a GD or case presentation round may be conducted to evaluate communication, structured thinking, and teamwork
7. **Personal Interview:** One or two rounds of interviews (technical/functional + HR) are conducted. Interviewers from the hiring department evaluate depth of knowledge and potential. HR evaluates culture fit, communication, and motivation
8. **Offer Letter & Acceptance:** Selected candidates receive an Offer Letter within 48 hours of the final decision. Candidates must accept or decline within the timeline specified by the institute (typically 24–72 hours per placement cell norms)

Real-World Example: On-Campus Hiring at IIT Kharagpur

In October 2024, the Company's HR team attended the Spring Internship Drive at IIT Kharagpur. A PPT was conducted for the Computer Science and Electrical Engineering departments. 120 students applied for 6 Software Engineering intern positions. After resume shortlisting (top 40), an online coding test was administered on HackerRank. The top 15 scorers proceeded to two rounds of technical interviews. Six candidates received offers within 24 hours, all of which were accepted. The entire on-campus process, from PPT to offer, was completed in 3 days.

2.2 Off-Campus Recruitment

Off-campus recruitment allows the Company to access talent beyond the institutions in its campus placement program. This channel is particularly useful for niche roles, mid-cycle hiring requirements, diversity hiring, and specialized domains not available at partner institutions.

Off-Campus Sourcing Methods

- **Job Portals:** LinkedIn, Internshala, Naukri, Indeed, Unstop (formerly HackerEarth Campus), and AngelList Talent are the Company's primary job posting platforms for intern roles

- **Company Career Page:** All intern openings are simultaneously posted on the official Company website under the Careers section
- **Social Media Campaigns:** HR runs targeted awareness campaigns on LinkedIn and Instagram, especially during peak hiring seasons (November–December and April–May)
- **Hackathons & Competitions:** The Company sponsors and/or participates in hackathons, case competitions, and design sprints. Top performers are extended fast-track internship offers
- **Walk-In Drives:** For high-volume requirements (e.g., Customer Support, Sales, Operations), HR may organize city-specific walk-in interview events

Off-Campus Selection Process

9. **Application Review:** All applications received via job portals and the career page are reviewed by HR within 5 business days. A resume screening checklist is used to maintain objectivity
10. **Initial HR Screening Call (15–20 minutes):** A basic telephonic or video screen to verify eligibility (current student or recent graduate), availability dates, location preference, and communication skills
11. **Technical/Functional Assessment:** Domain-specific evaluation — coding test for engineering roles, portfolio review for design roles, case study for business roles, writing test for content roles, financial model for finance roles
12. **Interview Rounds:** One to two rounds depending on role complexity. Conducted over video call (Google Meet, Zoom, or Microsoft Teams)
13. **Offer & Documentation:** Selected candidates receive a digital offer letter. Pre-joining documentation (educational certificates, student ID, bank account details for stipend) is collected digitally

Real-World Example: Off-Campus Hiring via Internshala

The Product team needed a UI/UX Design intern in February 2025 on short notice. HR posted a role on Internshala with a detailed JD specifying Figma proficiency and mobile-first design experience. Over 80 applications were received in one week. HR shortlisted 12 based on portfolio quality. All 12 completed a 2-hour design assignment. Five were interviewed by the Product Design Lead. Two interns were selected and onboarded within 10 days of the original posting.

2.3 Cold Outreach Recruitment

Cold outreach occurs when either the Company proactively contacts a potential intern candidate (Company-initiated), or when a candidate reaches out to the Company directly without an open posting (Candidate-initiated). Both are valid and actively encouraged hiring pathways.

Company-Initiated Cold Outreach

- Talent scouting is conducted primarily via LinkedIn, GitHub, Behance, Dribbble, Kaggle, and Medium, depending on the domain
- HR and department leads maintain a watchlist of high-potential students identified through competition results, open-source contributions, published articles, impressive project portfolios, or academic recognition
- A personalized outreach message is sent, clearly identifying the Company, the specific reason for reaching out (e.g., 'We saw your Kaggle competition ranking'), and the internship opportunity
- Candidates who respond positively enter the standard selection process beginning from the assessment stage (since resume review is replaced by the work already reviewed)
- All cold outreach must be logged in the ATS (Applicant Tracking System) and the Communication Compliance team must be notified for any outreach via personal email or non-platform channels

Candidate-Initiated Cold Outreach

- Candidates may email HR directly at careers@[company].com or message Company representatives on LinkedIn expressing interest in an internship
- HR acknowledges all such outreach within 3 business days. If no matching role exists, the candidate is informed and their profile is added to a Talent Pool for future consideration (with explicit consent)
- If a relevant role exists or a business need can justify it, the candidate is directed to apply formally through the career page or is fast-tracked into the interview process
- Exceptional candidates may trigger an opportunistic hire — where a department head evaluates the need and creates a role that did not previously exist, subject to budget approval

Real-World Example: Candidate-Initiated Cold Outreach

In March 2025, Priya Sharma, a third-year Economics student at Delhi University, emailed HR@[company].com with a detailed note about her interest in the Company's growth strategy, attaching a 12-page analysis she had independently prepared on the Company's market positioning. The HR team forwarded this to the Strategy and Business Development Head, who was immediately impressed. Priya was interviewed within 5 days and offered a 3-month Business Strategy internship — a role that was not publicly listed at the time.

2.4 Referral-Based Recruitment

The Company's Employee Referral Program (ERP) extends to intern hiring. Full-time employees may refer students or recent graduates for open or upcoming internship roles. Referrals are a trusted source of quality candidates because they come pre-vetted by someone who understands both the Company's culture and the candidate's capabilities.

Referral Program Rules & Process

14. Eligibility: Any full-time employee (excluding HR personnel involved in the specific hire) may submit an intern referral
15. Submission: Referrals must be submitted through the official HRMS Referral Portal with the candidate's resume, a short note from the referring employee explaining why they are recommending the candidate, and the role being referred for
16. Transparency: The referred candidate must be aware of and consent to the referral
17. Evaluation: Referred candidates are not automatically hired. They undergo the same selection process as all other candidates but are given priority scheduling for interviews (within 5 business days of referral submission)
18. Referral Incentive: Employees who successfully refer an intern who completes at least 4 weeks of the internship receive a referral bonus of ₹2,000 (credited to their next salary)
19. Conflict of Interest: Employees may not refer immediate family members (spouse, sibling, parent, child). Exceptions require prior written approval from the HR Head

Real-World Example: Referral Hiring in Action

Rohan Mehta, a Software Engineer at the Company, referred his college junior Aditya for an open Backend Engineering intern role. Rohan submitted the referral via the HRMS portal and noted that Aditya had contributed to three open-source projects and had experience with the Company's core tech stack. Aditya was shortlisted within 2 days, cleared the coding test and two technical rounds, and was offered the internship. Rohan received the ₹2,000 referral bonus after Aditya completed his first month.

2.5 Eligibility Criteria for All Interns

Regardless of the channel through which a candidate is identified, all intern candidates must meet the following minimum eligibility criteria:

Criterion	Requirement
Educational Status	Currently enrolled in an undergraduate (Year 1–4), postgraduate, or doctoral program OR a recent graduate (within 12 months of graduation date)
Minimum Age	18 years at the time of joining
Duration Availability	Minimum commitment of 6 weeks; maximum single-term engagement of 12 months
No Objection Certificate	If currently enrolled in a college, a No Objection Certificate (NOC) from the institution is mandatory before joining
Documentation	Valid government-issued ID, proof of enrollment or graduation, bank account details (savings account in intern's name)
Background Check	Basic background verification including identity and address verification (criminal history not checked for interns unless role involves financial access or vulnerable populations)

3. Intern Stipend Policy

The Company believes in fairly compensating interns for their time, effort, and contribution. All internships at the Company are paid. The stipend is calibrated based on role type, domain, the intern's academic year and qualifications, and the duration of the internship. Stipends range from ₹10,000 to ₹50,000 per month.

3.1 Stipend Structure by Domain & Level

The following table outlines the stipend bands applicable across all domains. These bands represent the minimum and maximum for each level and are reviewed annually by HR in consultation with Finance and Department Heads.

Domain	Junior (UG Year 1–2)	Mid (UG Year 3–4 / PG Year 1)	Senior (PG Year 2 / PhD)
Software Engineering / Tech	₹20,000 – ₹28,000	₹28,000 – ₹40,000	₹40,000 – ₹50,000
Data Science / AI / ML	₹22,000 – ₹30,000	₹30,000 – ₹42,000	₹42,000 – ₹50,000
Product Management	₹15,000 – ₹22,000	₹22,000 – ₹35,000	₹35,000 – ₹45,000
UI/UX Design	₹15,000 – ₹22,000	₹22,000 – ₹32,000	₹32,000 – ₹42,000
Marketing & Growth	₹12,000 – ₹18,000	₹18,000 – ₹28,000	₹28,000 – ₹38,000
Finance & Accounting	₹12,000 – ₹18,000	₹18,000 – ₹28,000	₹28,000 – ₹38,000
Sales & Business Dev.	₹10,000 – ₹16,000	₹16,000 – ₹25,000	₹25,000 – ₹35,000
HR & People Ops	₹10,000 – ₹15,000	₹15,000 – ₹22,000	₹22,000 – ₹30,000
Legal & Compliance	₹12,000 – ₹18,000	₹18,000 – ₹28,000	₹28,000 – ₹40,000
Content & Communications	₹10,000 – ₹15,000	₹15,000 – ₹22,000	₹22,000 – ₹30,000
Operations & Supply Chain	₹10,000 – ₹15,000	₹15,000 – ₹22,000	₹22,000 – ₹32,000
Research & Development	₹15,000 – ₹22,000	₹22,000 – ₹35,000	₹35,000 – ₹50,000

Note: The above stipends represent the full and only monetary compensation for interns. Interns are not eligible for performance bonuses, variable pay, medical reimbursement, LTA, or any other employee benefits unless explicitly stated in their individual offer letter.

3.2 Stipend Payment Schedule & Mechanics

- Stipend is paid monthly, on the last working day of each calendar month

- Payment is made directly to the intern's savings bank account via NEFT/IMPS. No cash payments are made under any circumstance
- Interns must submit their bank account details (account number, IFSC code, branch name) on or before Day 3 of joining. Failure to do so will delay stipend processing and the Company is not liable for such delays
- Interns joining mid-month receive a pro-rated stipend for the first month, calculated as: $(\text{Monthly Stipend} \div \text{Total Working Days in Month}) \times \text{Days Worked}$
- TDS (Tax Deducted at Source) is not applicable on intern stipends below ₹2,50,000 per annum. If a stipend arrangement exceeds this threshold, TDS will be deducted at applicable rates and Form 16A will be issued
- Interns receive a monthly pay stub via email from the payroll system, detailing gross stipend, any deductions, and net amount credited

3.3 Stipend Adjustment & Mid-Internship Revision

In exceptional cases, stipend revisions may be made mid-internship. These are rare but may occur in the following scenarios:

- **Extension of Internship:** If an intern's engagement is formally extended beyond the original offer period and the extension is at a higher responsibility level, HR may revise the stipend upward, subject to department head and Finance approval
- **Role Change:** If an intern is formally reassigned to a different (higher-complexity) role during the internship, the stipend is revised to match the new role's band
- **No Downward Revision:** The Company does not reduce an intern's stipend once it has been agreed upon in the offer letter, barring a mutual agreement in writing

Real-World Example: Stipend Revision on Extension

Neha Gupta joined as a Marketing intern at ₹18,000/month for a 2-month term. Her supervisor was so impressed with her work on a product launch campaign that the team requested a 3-month extension. Since her new responsibilities (end-to-end campaign ownership) matched the 'Mid' band, HR revised her stipend to ₹22,000/month for the extended period, effective from Month 3. A revised offer letter was issued.

3.4 Deductions & Forfeitures

- **No Pay for Unauthorized Absence:** Unexcused absences beyond 3 days in a month result in pro-rata deduction from the monthly stipend at the daily rate ($\text{Monthly Stipend} \div 26 \text{ working days} \times \text{Days Absent Beyond Threshold}$)
- **Early Departure:** If an intern voluntarily terminates before completing 50% of their contracted internship period without a valid reason (medical, family emergency), no exit certificate or letter of completion will be issued, and the final month's stipend will be held for 15 days pending handover verification
- **Damage/Loss of Company Assets:** If an intern is found responsible for loss or damage to Company property (laptop, equipment), the cost may be deducted from their stipend or final settlement, after a fair inquiry process

4. Pre-Placement Offer (PPO) — Pathway & Process

The Pre-Placement Offer (PPO) is the Company's mechanism for converting high-performing interns into full-time employees without the standard recruitment process. A PPO is a formal employment offer made to an intern before the end of their internship, with a joining date that typically aligns with their graduation. It is one of the most coveted outcomes of an internship at the Company and reflects the Company's commitment to building talent from within.

4.1 PPO Eligibility Criteria

Not all interns are eligible for a PPO. The following criteria must be satisfied for an intern to be evaluated for a PPO:

- **Minimum Internship Duration:** The intern must have completed at least 8 weeks (2 months) of their internship at the Company
- **Performance Rating:** The intern must receive a minimum performance score of 3.5 out of 5 (or equivalent) in their mid-term and final evaluations (see Section 8 for evaluation details)
- **Project Completion:** The intern must have substantially completed (at least 80%) their assigned primary project with documented, measurable outcomes
- **No Active Disciplinary Action:** The intern must not have any unresolved or active disciplinary action, attendance issues, or code of conduct violations on record
- **Supervisor Recommendation:** The direct supervisor must formally recommend the intern for PPO consideration through the HRMS system
- **Business Need:** A confirmed open (or upcoming) headcount for the role must exist in the department's approved hiring plan

4.2 PPO Evaluation Process

20. **Supervisor Nomination:** The direct supervisor submits a PPO recommendation via the HRMS portal no later than 2 weeks before the intern's last working day. The nomination includes a written justification and performance summary
21. **HR Review:** HR verifies the intern's eligibility (criteria above), reviews attendance records, and confirms that a suitable open headcount exists
22. **Departmental Approval:** The Department Head reviews the nomination and performance data and provides final approval or rejection. In case of rejection, HR communicates the

reason constructively to the supervisor (the intern is not informed of a rejection unless they specifically ask about PPO status)

23. Compensation Determination: The PPO compensation package (CTC, variable pay, joining bonus if any) is determined by HR and Finance based on the role's full-time salary band, the intern's performance level, and the current market benchmarks. The intern's past stipend has no bearing on the PPO CTC
24. PPO Issuance: Eligible interns receive a formal PPO letter, physically and digitally, no later than 3 days before their last working day at the Company. The PPO letter specifies the designation, department, location, CTC, variable component, joining date, and acceptance deadline
25. Acceptance Window: Interns have until 30 days after the PPO issuance date (or before their institute's placement season begins, whichever is earlier) to accept or decline the offer. Extension of the acceptance window requires written approval from HR Head
26. Post-Acceptance: Upon acceptance, the intern is registered in the Company's future employee pipeline. They receive pre-joining materials, company access provisioning details, and a welcome communication from their future manager

Real-World Example: PPO Conversion — End-to-End

Siddharth Verma, a final-year B.Tech student from NIT Surathkal, interned in the Data Engineering team for 3 months (June–August 2024) at a stipend of ₹35,000/month. By Week 6, he had independently built an internal data pipeline that reduced report generation time by 40%. His supervisor submitted a PPO recommendation on August 15. HR confirmed an open Senior Associate – Data Engineering headcount. The Department Head approved the nomination on August 17. Siddharth received a PPO letter on August 28 for the position of Junior Data Engineer with a CTC of ₹12 LPA. He accepted on September 5 and joined the Company full-time in July 2025, immediately after completing his final semester exams.

4.3 PPO Withdrawal

In rare circumstances, the Company reserves the right to withdraw a PPO before the intern joins as a full-time employee. Grounds for withdrawal include:

- Material misrepresentation in the application or during the internship (e.g., falsifying academic records)
- Gross misconduct or violation of the Company's Code of Conduct discovered after PPO issuance
- Significant organizational restructuring or financial constraints that eliminate the relevant headcount

- Failure to meet the stated joining date without prior notification to HR

In such cases, HR must provide written notice to the intern with at least 30 days' advance warning (except in cases of misconduct, where immediate withdrawal is permitted). The Company is not liable for any consequential damages arising from a withdrawal in good faith.

5. Intern Code of Conduct & Behavioral Standards

Interns are representatives of the Company during their tenure and are expected to conduct themselves with the highest degree of professionalism, integrity, and respect — both within the workplace and in any external capacity where they represent the Company. The following standards apply to all interns, irrespective of domain, location, or engagement mode.

5.1 Professional Conduct

- **Punctuality:** Interns must arrive at work (in-office or virtual) on time as per their scheduled shift. Chronic tardiness (more than 3 instances of >15-minute delays in a month) is treated as a conduct issue
- **Communication Etiquette:** All communications — email, Slack, Teams, or in-person — must be professional and respectful. Interns must respond to messages from supervisors or HR within 4 business hours during working hours
- **Dress Code:** For in-office days, smart casual attire is expected. For client-facing events, formal business attire is required. Remote video calls should be conducted in a tidy, well-lit environment, and interns should appear presentable on camera
- **Meeting Conduct:** Interns are expected to come prepared for all meetings (having reviewed the agenda), arrive on time, actively participate when relevant, and not use personal devices for non-meeting purposes during sessions
- **Hierarchy & Respect:** Interns must treat all colleagues — regardless of designation — with courtesy and respect. Any experience of disrespect, harassment, or bullying must be reported to HR immediately (see Grievance Redressal section)

5.2 Confidentiality & Data Security

Interns are required to sign a Confidentiality and Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) on their first day of joining. This NDA remains in effect for 2 years beyond the end of the internship. The following obligations apply:

- **Company Information:** Interns must not share any proprietary information, business data, client information, financial data, product roadmaps, or internal strategies with any external party
- **System Access:** Interns must not share their system login credentials, access cards, or passwords with anyone, including other interns or employees

- **Personal Devices:** Interns must not store Company data on personal devices or personal cloud storage (Google Drive, Dropbox, etc.) unless explicitly authorized in writing by their supervisor and the IT Security team
- **Social Media:** Interns must not post about the Company's unreleased products, strategies, internal conflicts, or financial performance on social media without prior approval from the Communications team. They may post positive professional updates about their internship experience with appropriate discretion
- **Post-Internship:** The NDA obligations continue even after the internship ends. Violation of confidentiality post-internship may result in legal action

5.3 Integrity & Ethics

- Interns must not engage in any form of plagiarism, academic or professional dishonesty, or falsification of work outputs
- Interns must disclose any conflict of interest (e.g., working simultaneously for a competitor, direct relative in the Company) to HR before or at the time of joining
- Interns must not accept gifts, favors, or inducements from vendors, clients, or external parties. Any such offer must be reported to HR
- Interns who witness fraud, financial irregularity, or any violation of Company policy are encouraged to report it through the official Whistleblower Channel (details in the Company's Code of Ethics document)

5.4 Prohibited Behaviors

The following behaviors constitute serious violations and may result in immediate termination of the internship without notice or final stipend payment:

- Workplace harassment (physical, verbal, sexual, or digital) of any colleague, vendor, or client
- Accessing systems, files, or areas for which the intern has not been explicitly authorized
- Unauthorized copying, downloading, or sharing of Company data or intellectual property
- Consumption of alcohol or controlled substances on Company premises or during Company-sponsored events
- Misrepresentation of work done, project status, or attendance records

- Engaging in activities that directly compete with the Company's business during the internship period without written disclosure and approval

Real-World Example: Conduct Violation — Immediate Termination

During an internal audit in 2024, it was discovered that an intern in the Finance team had been accessing financial reports beyond the scope of their assigned project and had shared a snapshot of an unreleased earnings summary with a college friend. Following an inquiry, the intern was immediately terminated, the NDA was formally invoked, and the Company's legal team sent a cease-and-desist notice. The incident reinforced the critical importance of access controls and regular audits for intern accounts.

6. Attendance Policy for Interns

Regular and consistent attendance is fundamental to the success of any internship. Interns are expected to be fully present — physically or virtually — during their designated working hours. This section outlines attendance norms for both in-office and work-from-home modalities, leave entitlements, and consequences of non-compliance.

6.1 Standard Working Hours

Parameter	Detail
Standard Working Hours	9:00 AM – 6:00 PM (with a 1-hour lunch break from 1:00 PM – 2:00 PM)
Total Daily Hours	8 hours of productive work per day
Working Days	Monday to Friday (5 days/week). Saturday and Sunday are off.
Public Holidays	Interns follow the Company's official Holiday Calendar (published by HR at the start of each year)
Flexible Hours	Subject to supervisor approval, interns may work flex hours (e.g., 10 AM – 7 PM) with prior written consent. Core hours of 11 AM – 4 PM remain mandatory
Overtime	Interns are not expected to work overtime. If project urgency requires it, compensatory leave (comp-off) is provided within 2 weeks. No additional stipend is paid for overtime hours

6.2 In-Office Attendance

In-office attendance applies to interns who are assigned to a physical Company office location as per their offer letter, and on days when their work mode is designated as in-office.

27. **Attendance Marking:** Interns must mark their attendance using the Company's biometric system or digital attendance portal (HRMS) upon arrival and departure. Attendance must be marked within 15 minutes of arriving and before leaving the premises
28. **Late Arrival Grace Period:** A grace period of 15 minutes is allowed (i.e., marking attendance by 9:15 AM). Beyond this, the late arrival is recorded. Three or more late arrivals in a month are treated as one day of unauthorized absence for stipend calculation purposes
29. **Early Departure:** Interns must not leave the office before the standard end of work (6:00 PM) without supervisor approval. Early departures must be marked in the HRMS system

- 30. Off-Site Work: If an intern is required to attend an external event, client site, or field visit as part of their project, the supervisor must pre-approve this in the HRMS system, and attendance is marked as 'On-Duty'
- 31. Visitor Policy: Interns may not invite personal guests (friends, family) to Company premises without prior approval from Administration and their supervisor

6.3 Work-From-Home Attendance

WFH arrangements for interns may be offered based on role type, team norms, and individual circumstances. WFH is a privilege, not a right, and requires supervisor approval.

- 32. WFH Eligibility: Interns may be permitted to work from home (fully or partially) if: (a) their role does not require physical presence (e.g., software, content, design), (b) their supervisor approves, and (c) they have demonstrated consistent attendance and productivity in-office for at least the first 2 weeks
- 33. Daily Check-In: WFH interns must mark daily attendance by 9:15 AM via the HRMS mobile app or web portal. Additionally, they must send a Morning Stand-Up Message to their supervisor by 9:30 AM listing: tasks planned for the day, any blockers, and availability
- 34. Daily Wrap-Up: By 6:00 PM (or end of shift), WFH interns must submit an End-of-Day Update in writing (HRMS task tracker or designated team channel) listing: tasks completed, tasks carried forward, and any follow-ups needed
- 35. Video Calls: WFH interns are required to be available on video for all team meetings and one-on-ones. Camera-on is mandatory for stand-up meetings and performance reviews. Camera may be turned off during large all-hands calls
- 36. Connectivity: Interns are responsible for ensuring a reliable internet connection on WFH days. Connectivity issues must be proactively communicated to the supervisor. Persistent connectivity problems may result in requiring in-office attendance
- 37. WFH Revocation: The supervisor or HR may revoke WFH privileges at any time if productivity, attendance, or communication standards are not being maintained

Real-World Example: WFH Attendance Process in Practice

Arjun, a Content intern working remotely from Pune, sends a Slack message to his supervisor every morning by 9:15 AM: 'Morning! Plan for today: (1) Draft blog post on feature X, (2) Review social media calendar for July, (3) Coordinate with Design for infographic assets. No blockers.' By 6:00 PM he posts in the team channel: 'EOD update: Blog draft complete and shared in Drive. Social calendar reviewed and flagged 3 dates for approval. Design coordination

scheduled for tomorrow 10 AM. Carry forward: Infographic brief.' This simple routine ensures his supervisor has full visibility without micromanaging.

6.4 Leave Entitlement for Interns

Leave Type	Entitlement & Conditions
Casual Leave (CL)	1 day per month of internship (e.g., a 3-month intern gets 3 CL days). Requires 24-hour prior notice except in genuine emergencies. Not encashable.
Medical Leave	Up to 2 days per month with a valid medical certificate. Certificate must be submitted to HR within 3 days of returning. Unsupported medical leave is treated as unauthorized absence.
Emergency Leave	Up to 2 days per calendar quarter for family emergencies (bereavement, critical illness of immediate family). Must be communicated to supervisor as soon as possible and approved by HR post-fact.
Exam Leave	Interns currently enrolled in academic programs may take exam leave for scheduled university examinations. Exam timetable must be shared with HR and supervisor at least 2 weeks in advance. Stipend is not deducted for approved exam leave.
Unauthorized Absence	Any absence not covered by the above categories. Results in pro-rata stipend deduction and, if exceeding 3 days in a month, triggers a formal review by HR and supervisor.
Carry Forward & Encashment	Unused leave is not carried forward to the next month and cannot be encashed. Interns are encouraged to use leaves as they accrue.

7. Project Allotment Policy

Project allotment is at the heart of the internship experience. The Company is committed to assigning interns to real, high-impact work — not fabricated tasks, filing, or peripheral activities. Every intern deserves to leave their internship with a tangible portfolio contribution they can be proud of.

7.1 Principles of Project Allotment

- **Relevance:** Projects must be directly relevant to the intern's domain and the learning outcomes defined in the offer letter
- **Ownership:** Each intern must have a clearly defined primary project for which they hold ownership and accountability, with a defined beginning, middle, and end within their internship period
- **Scope Calibration:** Projects must be realistically scoped to the intern's skill level and available time. An intern should be stretched but not overwhelmed — the 'challenge sweet spot' is 70% within their current capability, 30% requires new learning
- **Business Value:** Projects should generate real business value. Interns should be able to articulate the impact of their work in measurable terms upon completion (e.g., 'Reduced page load time by 35%', 'Generated 150 qualified leads', 'Automated a 4-hour manual process')
- **Documentation:** Every project must have a written Project Brief (assigned by supervisor) and the intern must maintain a Project Log throughout the internship

7.2 Types of Projects by Domain

The following provides representative project types for each domain. These are illustrative and not exhaustive.

Technology & Engineering

- **Feature Development:** Building new features on the Company's live product (web, mobile, API)
- **Bug Squashing & Code Review:** Identifying, fixing, and documenting bugs in the existing codebase
- **Performance Optimization:** Profiling and improving the performance of application components

- Internal Tools: Building internal dashboards, automation scripts, or developer tooling
- Infrastructure: Working on CI/CD pipelines, cloud infrastructure configuration, database optimization

Data Science & AI/ML

- Model Development: Building, training, and evaluating ML models for real business problems
- Data Pipeline: Creating or improving ETL pipelines for business intelligence
- Analytics Projects: Performing exploratory data analysis and generating business insights
- Research & Experimentation: Running A/B tests, NLP experiments, or computer vision prototypes

Product Management

- Feature Spec: Writing comprehensive Product Requirement Documents (PRDs) for upcoming features
- User Research: Conducting user interviews, surveys, and usability tests; synthesizing findings
- Competitive Analysis: In-depth competitive landscape analysis with recommendations
- Metrics & Analytics: Defining and tracking key product metrics using analytics tools (Mixpanel, Amplitude)

Design (UI/UX)

- End-to-End Design: Researching, wireframing, prototyping, and user-testing a product feature
- Design System: Contributing to or updating the Company's component library in Figma
- Brand Work: Creating marketing collateral, social media templates, or pitch deck templates
- Usability Audit: Evaluating an existing product flow and proposing evidence-based improvements

Marketing & Growth

- Campaign Execution: End-to-end execution of a specific performance or content marketing campaign

- SEO/SEM Projects: Keyword research, content gap analysis, on-page SEO implementation
- Social Media: Building and executing a content calendar, analyzing engagement metrics
- Market Research: Primary or secondary research to support a new market or product strategy

Finance

- Financial Modeling: Building or updating valuation models, DCF models, or budget trackers
- Reporting: Monthly MIS reports, variance analysis, P&L review
- Due Diligence: Supporting M&A or investor-related financial due diligence processes

Real-World Example: Project Allotment — Software Engineering

When Aman joined as a Backend Engineering intern at the Company in May 2024, his supervisor assigned him as the primary owner of the 'Notification Service Redesign' project — a real production initiative to move from a legacy notification system to an event-driven microservices architecture using Kafka. The Project Brief specified clear deliverables: architecture diagram (Week 2), prototype (Week 4), testing and staging deployment (Week 6), production rollout (Week 8). By the end of his 3-month internship, the new notification service was live and handling 2 million events per day — a genuine, measurable business contribution.

7.3 Project Assignment Process

38. Before Joining: The supervisor prepares a tentative project plan and Project Brief before the intern's first day. This ensures the intern starts productively on Day 1 rather than spending the first week 'finding their feet' without direction
39. Day 1 Briefing: On the first day, the supervisor walks the intern through the Project Brief, the tools they will use, team members they will collaborate with, and expected milestones
40. Week 1 Alignment: By end of Week 1, the intern and supervisor meet to formally confirm the project scope, refine milestones, and ensure the intern has all necessary access and resources
41. Mid-Term Review: At the midpoint of the internship, a formal project review meeting is held to assess progress against milestones, address blockers, and if necessary, recalibrate scope
42. Final Presentation: In the last week, the intern presents their project outcomes to the team and/or department. This is a key deliverable and forms a major part of the final performance evaluation

8. Performance Expectations & Evaluation Framework

Clear performance expectations enable interns to understand what success looks like and supervisors to provide fair, evidence-based evaluations. The Company uses a structured evaluation framework with formal checkpoints at the mid-point and end of the internship.

8.1 Core Performance Dimensions

All interns are evaluated on five core dimensions, regardless of domain:

Dimension	What It Measures
Technical / Functional Skills (30%)	Quality, accuracy, and depth of work output specific to the role — code quality, design fidelity, analytical rigour, writing quality, financial accuracy, etc.
Problem-Solving & Initiative (20%)	Ability to identify issues, think independently, propose solutions without being prompted, and show intellectual curiosity beyond the assigned scope
Collaboration & Communication (20%)	Quality of written and verbal communication, effectiveness in team settings, clarity in presenting ideas, proactive status updates to supervisors
Ownership & Accountability (20%)	Taking end-to-end responsibility for assigned work, meeting deadlines, flagging risks early, following through on commitments
Learning Agility (10%)	Speed and quality of learning new tools, concepts, and processes; openness to feedback; improvement visible between mid-term and final evaluation

8.2 Evaluation Schedule & Ratings

Performance evaluations are conducted at two formal touchpoints: Mid-Term (at the midpoint of the internship) and Final (in the last week).

- Rating Scale: 1 (Far Below Expectations) | 2 (Below Expectations) | 3 (Meets Expectations) | 4 (Exceeds Expectations) | 5 (Outstanding)
- The weighted average across five dimensions produces the Overall Performance Score (OPS) out of 5
- OPS of 4.0 and above qualifies the intern for PPO consideration (plus all other PPO criteria in Section 4)

- OPS of 3.5–3.9 indicates a strong intern who met expectations and will receive a positive internship completion certificate
- OPS below 3.0 triggers the Performance Improvement Protocol (see Section 9.2)

Evaluation Process

- 43. Self-Assessment: 2 weeks before mid-term and final evaluation dates, the intern submits a self-assessment via HRMS covering project progress, achievements, challenges, and personal growth
- 44. Supervisor Assessment: The supervisor completes the evaluation form independently, rating the intern on each dimension with written justification
- 45. Calibration: For interns rated 5 on any dimension, or below 3 on any dimension, the Department Head reviews and approves the rating to ensure fairness
- 46. Feedback Session: A 45-minute face-to-face (or video) feedback meeting is held between supervisor and intern. The supervisor shares the detailed evaluation, explains ratings, and the intern has the opportunity to respond or seek clarification
- 47. Internship Completion Certificate: Based on the final OPS, a completion certificate graded as Pass / Pass with Distinction (OPS 4.0+) / Pass with Commendation (OPS 4.5+) is issued

Real-World Example: Performance Evaluation — Outstanding Rating

Kavya, a Data Science intern, received a final OPS of 4.7. Her supervisor noted: 'Kavya independently identified a data quality issue that had been invisible to the full-time team for 6 months and fixed it proactively — saving approximately 15% in erroneous model predictions. Her communication throughout was exemplary, and she delivered every milestone ahead of schedule.' Kavya received a Pass with Commendation certificate and was extended a PPO for a Data Analyst role.

8.3 Specific Performance Expectations by Internship Stage

Stage	Performance Expectations
Weeks 1–2 (Ramp-Up)	Complete onboarding tasks; understand the product/business; get tools and access set up; have the first project meeting with supervisor; demonstrate curiosity and proactive questions
Weeks 3–5 (Early Execution)	Begin producing first tangible work outputs; meet first project milestone; seek feedback proactively; demonstrate ability to work independently on defined sub-tasks

Stage	Performance Expectations
Mid-Term (Week 6 of a 12-week internship)	Substantially complete first milestone; present progress to team; receive and act on mid-term feedback; show improvement from Week 1 baseline
Weeks 7–10 (Deep Execution)	Primary ownership of project in full swing; iterating based on feedback; collaborating with cross-functional stakeholders; managing own time and deliverables independently
Final Week	Project substantially complete; final presentation prepared and delivered; documentation completed; handover notes submitted; all Company assets and access returned

9. System Access, Supervision & Remedial Procedures

9.1 System Access & Permissions for Interns

The Company follows a least-privilege access model for interns — interns are granted only the minimum access required to perform their specific role. Access is categorized into four tiers:

Access Tier	Details & Examples
Tier 1 — Standard Access (All Interns)	Company email account (@[company].com), Slack or Teams workspace (relevant channels only), HRMS self-service portal, designated project management tool (Jira, Asana, Trello), shared knowledge base (Confluence, Notion), video conferencing (Google Meet/Zoom), corporate Wi-Fi
Tier 2 — Role-Specific Access	Engineering interns: GitHub (read/write on assigned repos), staging environment, dev/test databases. Design interns: Figma workspace (assigned projects). Marketing interns: Google Analytics (view-only or filtered access), social media scheduling tools. Finance interns: relevant sections of ERP (read-only unless explicitly extended)
Tier 3 — Restricted Access (Requires Department Head + IT Approval)	Production databases, live customer data (only if role demands and data is anonymized), code deployment pipelines, financial systems with write access. Such access requires a written business justification, IT Security sign-off, and mandatory data handling training completion
Tier 4 — No Access (Never Granted to Interns)	Executive communications and strategy documents, full customer PII (Personally Identifiable Information), HR records of full-time employees, audit trails, legal case files, investor information, payroll data

- Access Provisioning Timeline: All Tier 1 access is provisioned by 12:00 PM on Day 1. Tier 2 access must be provisioned by end of Day 2. Tier 3 access takes up to 5 business days after approval is received
- Access Audit: IT Security conducts a quarterly audit of all intern access permissions and revokes any access that is no longer necessary
- Access Termination: All access is immediately revoked on the last working day of the internship (or earlier if the internship is terminated early). Supervisors must submit an Access Termination Request to IT on the intern's penultimate day

9.2 Supervision Structure

Every intern is assigned a dedicated Supervisor — a full-time employee at the level of Senior Associate or above — who is responsible for the intern's day-to-day guidance, project oversight, and formal evaluation. Supervision is a formal responsibility and supervisors are evaluated on the quality of their intern management as part of their own annual performance review.

Supervisor Responsibilities

- Pre-Joining: Prepare Project Brief, plan access provisioning, schedule Week 1 agenda, brief the team on the intern's arrival
- Week 1: Conduct thorough onboarding (product walkthrough, team introductions, tool setup), assign the primary project, set clear expectations
- Weekly Check-ins: Hold a minimum 30-minute 1:1 with the intern every week throughout the internship. These must be documented in HRMS with brief notes
- Mid-Term Evaluation: Complete the formal mid-term performance review and conduct the feedback session within the designated window
- Project Guidance: Be available for questions and unblocking — interns should never be stuck on a problem for more than 1 business day without supervisor input
- PPO Recommendation: Proactively evaluate PPO eligibility and submit recommendation in time
- Final Evaluation & Certificate: Complete the final evaluation, conduct the feedback session, and approve the completion certificate
- Offboarding: Ensure all Company assets, access credentials, and project documentation are properly handed over

□ **Note:** Supervisors may delegate day-to-day task management to a Senior Intern, Team Lead, or experienced colleague, but the formal evaluation responsibility, PPO recommendation authority, and disciplinary escalation duty remain with the designated Supervisor.

9.3 When Expectations Are Not Being Met — Remedial Protocol

Not all interns will perform to the expected standard at all times. The Company's approach to underperformance is structured, fair, and focuses on enabling the intern to improve before escalating to termination.

Stage 1: Informal Coaching (Days 1–14 of Issue Identification)

When a supervisor identifies that an intern is underperforming — whether in quality of work, communication, attendance, or conduct — the first step is an informal, documented coaching conversation. The supervisor should:

48. Schedule a private one-on-one meeting within 3 business days of identifying the concern
49. Clearly describe the specific behaviors or outputs that are falling short, with examples (e.g., 'Your last three code submissions had critical bugs that were not caught in your own testing. The expected standard is for code to be self-tested before submission')
50. Ask open-ended questions to understand root causes (skill gap? unclear expectations? personal issues? workload?)
51. Collaboratively define 2–3 specific, measurable improvements the intern needs to make within the next 2 weeks
52. Document the conversation in HRMS under the intern's profile and send a written summary to the intern via email. CC HR

Stage 2: Formal Performance Improvement Plan — PIP (Days 15–30)

If the informal coaching does not produce visible improvement within 2 weeks, the supervisor must initiate a formal Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) in consultation with HR.

53. The PIP is a written document outlining: specific performance gaps, clear improvement targets with measurable criteria, timeline (typically 2–4 weeks), support available to the intern (additional training, mentorship, resource access), and consequence of non-improvement (internship termination)
54. The PIP is reviewed and signed by the supervisor, HR representative, and the intern. All parties receive a copy
55. The supervisor meets with the intern twice per week during the PIP period to provide feedback and track progress
56. At the end of the PIP period, HR and supervisor jointly assess whether targets have been met. If met: the intern continues with a monitoring note on their record. If not met: internship is terminated per Stage 3

Stage 3: Internship Termination

57. HR issues a written notice of termination with at least 5 business days' notice (except for gross misconduct, which is immediate)

- 58. The intern is entitled to a private exit conversation with HR to understand the reasons and receive constructive feedback
- 59. Stipend is settled for all days worked up to and including the last working day
- 60. No PPO recommendation is made. The internship completion certificate indicates 'Internship Concluded'
- 61. All access is revoked immediately upon notification of termination. An asset return form is completed and signed by the intern

Real-World Example: Remedial Protocol in Practice

Rohit, a Marketing intern, was consistently missing his weekly content deliverables and not responding to Slack messages within the expected window. His supervisor, Sneha, documented a coaching conversation in Week 3, setting specific targets: 2 blog posts per week submitted by Friday 5 PM, Slack responses within 3 hours during work hours. By Week 5, the issues persisted. HR was looped in and a formal PIP was initiated for 3 weeks with twice-weekly check-ins. By Week 8, Rohit had met all PIP targets for the final 2 weeks. Sneha and HR agreed to keep him on for the remaining 3 weeks of his internship with close monitoring. Rohit ultimately completed the internship but did not receive a PPO recommendation given the overall performance trajectory.

Policy Acknowledgement

All interns are required to read this policy in full and sign the Intern Policy Acknowledgement Form on Day 1 of their joining. By signing, the intern confirms they have understood all provisions of this policy and agree to abide by them throughout their internship. The signed form is maintained on file by HR for the duration of the internship and for 12 months thereafter. For any clarifications or queries regarding this policy, interns and supervisors may contact the HR team at [hr@\[company\].com](mailto:hr@[company].com).

— End of Intern Policy Document —